

Intentional Rescue

A STUDY IN STANCE

1ST REPORT – DESIGN OF PHYSICALLY GROUNDED COMMUNICATION SYSTEM

Hairong Shi • Keio University • Spring 2026

Play the film first.

NO EXPLANATION. LET THE ROOM READ IT.

75 seconds. Two robots. A wall. We attribute intention to the shapes before any commentary; that attribution is the subject of this talk.

The Rescue.

TWO ROBOTS, SEPARATED. ONE FINDS A WAY BACK.

TOGETHER

two robots breathe in the same room.

SEPARATION

a wall rises. Friend dims. Hero pauses.

DELIBERATION

Hero considers two possible futures.

JOURNEY

Hero ignores a sparkle, re-routes around a new wall.

REUNION

Hero arrives. Friend brightens. They breathe together.

Six hints, five beats.

FROM DIST-04, MAPPED TO WHERE THE FILM SHOWS IT.

INTENTION HINT

Tries to achieve a goal

Acts consciously

Persists; does not give up

Focuses on the main target

Simulates future worlds

Models the other agent / self

WHERE IT APPEARS

Throughout. Hero moves only toward Friend.

Beat 3. Hero pauses before moving — the deliberation.

Beat 4. Wall 2 rises; Hero re-plans, does not return.

Beat 4. The sparkle drifts past, ignored.

Beat 3. Two ghost paths flicker as candidate futures.

Throughout. Plan is computed against Friend's pose.

Two readings, side by side.

THE VIEWER ATTRIBUTES; THE CHYRON CONFIRMS.

EXTERNAL – INTENTIONAL STANCE

The viewer sees coloured discs
and tells the story: she got
hurt, he is going around the
wall to reach her.

Heider & Simmel, 1944.

Dennett, 1971.

The point is the alignment: each beat the chyron names,
the viewer's reading also names.

INTERNAL – BELIEF / DESIRE / PLAN

A documentary chyron exposes
what the agent holds:

belief: friend is on the other side

desire: reach the friend

plan: go above

Baker et al., 2017.

Cohen & Levesque, 1990.

How the film was made.

FRAMES GENERATED PROGRAMMATICALLY – NO SCREEN RECORDING.

PYGAME

anti-aliased discs and lines on an alpha layer.

NUMPY / SCIPY

post-processing: soft bloom (gaussian highlights),
motion trails (alpha-decayed accumulator), paper grain.

IMAGEIO-FFMPEG

streams frames to mp4 — 75 s at 30 fps, 1280×720.

TYPOGRAPHY

Charter (serif) + Avenir Next (sans, small caps for labels).
This deck and the film share the same palette and faces.

CODE

github.com/nanase1025/intentional-rescue

What I would like evaluated.

THREE ANGLES, IN ORDER OF IMPORTANCE.

1. *Alignment.*

Does the external reading you produced while watching agree with the BDI chyron at each beat?

2. *Restraint.*

Intention is conveyed without faces, language, or scored music. Is the attribution still robust?

3. *Scope.*

I deliberately stop at goal-directed individual action.
Communication and joint attention are out of frame.
Is that scope the right scope for the first task?

What the film does not show.

DRAWING THE PERIMETER IS PART OF THE DESIGN.

<i>No communication.</i>	joint attention and communicative intention sit later in the course.
<i>No Bayesian inference.</i>	the chyron uses BToM vocabulary; the agent is a finite plan.
<i>No nested mentalising.</i>	Hero models the Friend's pose, not the Friend's mind.
<i>No physical grounding.</i>	no sensors, no actuators — a thought-experiment, not a robot.

Watch it again.

NOW THE LABELS ARE IN YOUR HEAD.

The same 75 seconds. The same shapes. The reading shifts because the chyron has tied each attribution to a belief, desire, or plan.

Reading behind the film.

ALL ON THE SYLLABUS.

Dennett, D. Intentional Systems. J. Phil. 68, 1971.

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Behavior. Am. J. Psych. 57, 1944.

Epley, N., Waytz, A., Cacioppo, J. On Seeing Human.

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THANK YOU.